School of Health Studies

Western HealthSciences

HS3250F: Global Health Promotion

Fall | 2025

Prerequisites: Minimum of 60% [mandatory] in each of Health Sciences 1001A/B and Health Sciences 1002A/B.
Note: Unless you have either the requisites for this course or written special permission from your Dean to enroll in it, you may be removed from this course and it will be deleted from your record. This decision may not be appealed. You will receive no adjustment to your fees in the event that you are dropped from a course for failing to have the necessary prerequisites.

Course Information
Instructor: Ezezika, O.
Email: oezezika@uwo.ca
Office Hours: By appointment
Lectures: In person

Land Acknowledgement
We acknowledge that Western University is located on the traditional territories of the Anishinaabek, Haudenosaunee, Lūnaapéewak and Chonnonton Nations, on lands connected with the London Township and Sombra Treaties of 1796 and the Dish with One Spoon Covenant Wampum. This land continues to be home to diverse Indigenous Peoples who we recognize as contemporary stewards of the land and vital contributors of our society.

Accessibility Acknowledgement
Meaningful ways to incorporate equity into the student experience are important to the School of Health studies. To that end, we honour all manner of differences inherent within the student population and incorporate accessible options for inclusion to the best of our abilities in each course offering.

Course Description

As the world becomes more interdependent and the health of individuals and the health of nations are increasingly interrelated, global health is of vital concern. Designed for an interdisciplinary student mix, this course will explore issues identified as significant determinants of health (poverty, disease, illiteracy, environmental degradation) and strategies (activism, community development) to promote health within a global context. This case-study-oriented course will focus on the application of global principles in addressing current cases in global health. This course will also examine the social, political, and economic milieu in which these cases exist, as well as the applying the principles and knowledge gleaned from the lectures, readings, and discussions to solving real-life cases in global health.

Course Goals

1. Develop an understanding of current and future global disease burdens and why population health is so poor in many developing countries
2. Learn how to design, implement, and scale innovations to address global health challenges, particularly in resource-constrained settings.

Learning Objectives

Students who successfully complete this course have reliably demonstrated the ability to:

- Develop an understanding of past, present, and future global disease burdens
- Critically assess relevant research to evaluate previous achievements and future initiatives Generate practical and sustainable ideas for improving global health outcomes Differentiate types of global health actors and their different promotion efforts
- Identify strategies used to prevent or treat diseases in successful global health projects Execute problem-solving steps to complete various global health case study assignments

Course Format and Timetable

Lectures

Global health is widely recognized as a field of study and research focused on improving health outcomes for all people worldwide, often through transnational collaboration. Grounded in this central theme, this course introduces students to key concepts in understanding, measuring, and

setting priorities for past, present, and emerging global health challenges.

Students will explore the complex interplay of social, environmental, economic, and political determinants of health, and examine the roles that various global health actors play in shaping these relationships. The course includes three hours of weekly instruction, consisting of a primary lecture that incorporates short presentations, case studies, audio-visual materials, and Socratic-style discussions—a pedagogical approach that uses guided questioning to promote critical thinking and group engagement. In addition, students will participate in structured group discussions and receive guidance on key topics. Although there are no participation or attendance grades, students are strongly encouraged to attend lectures and actively engage in class and case study discussions. Ample time will be provided for questions, open dialogue, and feedback on case-specific content.

Week	Topic	Required Reading
Week 1 **Sept 4**	**What Is Global Health I** ▪ Understand the scope of the subjects covered by the term "global health" ▪ Start to apply human faces and experiences to the broad concepts of poverty, malnutrition, and injustice	Chapter 1 Ezezika, O.C. (2016). Building Trust: A Critical Component of Global Health. Annals of Global Health, 81(5), pp.589–592 http://doi.org/10.1016/j.aogh.2015.12.007
Week 2 **Sept 11**	**What Is Global Health II** ▪ Understand the scope of the subjects covered by the term "global health" ▪ Understand how global health relates to the new **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**	Chapter 1
Week 3 **Sept 18**	**How to Define and Measure Health** ▪ Understand the central importance of defining and measuring health outcomes in improving the effectiveness of aid projects. ▪ Appreciate the difference between simply counting the extent of disease and measuring the societal burden of disease. ▪ Know the definitions of the commonly used health variables ▪ Understand how data is collected and appreciate the range of errors involved	Chapter 9, 10
Week 4 **Sept 25**	**A History of International Aid** ▪ Understand the broad trends that have shaped the modern aid industry since its start after World War II ▪ Understand the origins of the principal foreign aid institutions and organizations.	Chapter 2, 11

	▪ Gain insight into the long history of trial and error that lies behind the current large-scale foreign aid initiatives ▪ Appreciate the rapidly changing world of aid in the new millennium	
Week 5 **Oct 2 (Thu)**	**The Basic Requirements for a Healthy Life** ▪ Evaluate the principal requirements for a healthy life, particularly the contributions of income, medical care, and social equity ▪ Appreciate some of the complex determinants of health that appear once the basic needs have been met ▪ Understand that a knowledge of the major determinants of health is an essential foundation for anyone interested in designing effective development strategies	Chapters 3
Week 6: **October 9**	**Midterm (designated assessment)**	
Week 7 **Oct 16**	**Water, Sanitation, and Infectious Diseases in Developing Countries I** ▪ Appreciate the absolutely central place of water and sanitation in population health and the cost- effective nature of hygiene initiatives ▪ Appreciate the extent of poor living standards around the world and the huge numbers of people who do not have access to clean water or sanitation ▪ Understand the pathology and treatment of the three major infectious diseases—malaria, HIV/AIDS, and tuberculosis ▪ Appreciate the range of less well-known but still important infectious diseases ▪ Understand the pathology and treatment of the major infectious diseases of children ▪ **Reflection I due on Tue Oct 14*	Chapters 8

Week 8 **Oct 23**	**Water, Sanitation, and Infectious Diseases in Developing Countries II** ▪ Appreciate the absolutely central place of water and sanitation in population health and the cost- effective nature of hygiene initiatives ▪ Appreciate the extent of poor living standards around the world and the huge numbers of people who do not have access to clean water or sanitation ▪ Understand the pathology and treatment of the three major infectious diseases—malaria, HIV/AIDS, and tuberculosis ▪ Appreciate the range of less well-known but still important infectious diseases ▪ Understand the pathology and treatment of the major infectious diseases of children	Chapter 8 Ezezika, O., Mengistu, M., Opoku, E., Farheen, A., Chauhan, A., & Barrett, K. (2022). What are the barriers and facilitators to polio vaccination and eradication programs? A systematic review. PLOS global public health, 2(11), e0001283. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pgph.0001283
Week 9 **Oct 30**	**Malnutrition I (Food Security)** ▪ Evaluate the underlying causes, adverse effects, and prevalence of malnutrition in developing countries. ▪ Understand the different types of malnutrition (ranging from micronutrient to macronutrient deficiencies) ▪ Understand the main methods used to measure and define malnutrition in population studies. ▪ Understand the common causes of inadequate food supply, and the complexities and problems associated with food aid to developing countries	Chapter 6
Reading Week	**November 3-9**	
Week 10 **Nov 13**	**Malnutrition II (Nutrition Transition)** • Examine how shifting diets and lifestyles contribute to the double burden of malnutrition. • Differentiate between undernutrition, micronutrient deficiencies, and rising overnutrition. • Identify methods used to measure nutritional status during periods of dietary change. • Analyze how urbanization, globalization, and food systems impact nutrition and complicate food aid.	Chapters 12

Week 11 **Nov 20**	**Primary Health Care Strategies: The Essential Foundation I** ▪ Understand the central importance of preventive medicine and health promotion strategies in the maintenance of population health ▪ Appreciate the practical problems associated with implementing primary health care initiatives ▪ understand the evolution of primary health care strategies and their contribution to current maternal and child-care initiatives. ▪ understand the organization and funding of developing world health services.	Chapter 12, 13
Week 12 **Nov 27**	**No Class/Final Reflection** **Reflection II due on Thu Nov 27*	
Week 13 **Dec 4**	**Planning and Preparing for Safe and Effective Development Work** Prepare and plan for an overseas development project ▪ Appreciate the ethical problems associated with aid projects. ▪ Know how to stay healthy working in a developing country Understand how to work effectively and co-operatively in a new culture.	Chapters 18, 19 Ezezika, O. C. 2014. How do you build trust with communities involved in your research? SciDev.Net's practical guides, Science and Development Network: www.scidev.net/global/communication/practical-guide/engage-participants- field-research.html

Evaluation

Assessment	Weight (%)	Dates
Midterm	25%	Oct 09
Reflection I	12.5%	Oct 14
Reflection II	12.5%	Nov 27
Participation	15%	Ongoing
Final Exam	35%	Dec 11-22

Designated Assessment: Only the **Midterm** is considered a designated assessment. Academic consideration for this assessment requires official documentation submitted as soon as possible, and no later than 48 hours after the missed assessment.

Textbook and Other Learning Materials

Seear, Michael, and Obidimma Ezezika. An Introduction to Global Health, 3rd edition, Canadian Scholars Press, 2018. The textbook costs **$118.95 (print), $100.95 (eBook – Fixed Layout), or $100.95 (eBook – Reflowable)**. Alternatively, students can view pricing and purchase

options on the publisher's website: https://www.canadianscholars.ca/books/an-introduction-to-global-health-3rd- edition. Students are welcome to purchase second-hand or earlier editions of this textbook.

Course/University Policies

Support Services

There are various support services around campus and these include, but are not limited to:

1. Academic Support and Engagement - http://academicsupport.uwo.ca
2. Wellness and Well-being - https://www.uwo.ca/health/
3. Registrar's Office -- http://www.registrar.uwo.ca/
4. Ombuds Office -- http://www.uwo.ca/ombuds/

The websites for Registrarial Services (http://www.registrar.uwo.ca), and the same for affiliated university colleges when appropriate, and any appropriate Student Support Services (including the services provided by the USC listed here: http://westernusc.ca/services/) and the Student Development Services, should be provided for easy access.

Students who are in emotional/mental distress should refer to Mental Health@Western (https://www.uwo.ca/health/) for a complete list of options about how to obtain help.

Statement on Gender-Based and Sexual Violence

Western is committed to reducing incidents of gender-based and sexual violence and providing compassionate support to anyone who has gone through these traumatic events. If you have experienced sexual or gender-based violence (either recently or in the past), you will find information about support services for survivors, including emergency contacts at:

https://www.uwo.ca/health/student_support/survivor_support/get-help.html.

Student Code of Conduct

The purpose of the Code of Student Conduct is to define the general standard of conduct expected of students registered at Western University, provide examples of behaviour that constitutes a breach of this standard of conduct, provide examples of sanctions that may be imposed and set out the disciplinary procedures that the University will follow. For more information, visit https://www.uwo.ca/univsec/pdf/board/code.pdf

Absence from Course Commitments

Students must familiarize themselves with the Policy on Academic Consideration – Undergraduate Students in First Entry Programs

Students missing course work for medical, compassionate, or extenuating circumstances can request academic consideration by completing a request through the central academic consideration portal (Student Absence Portal). Students are permitted one academic consideration request per course per term **without** supporting documentation. Note that supporting documentation is **always** required for academic consideration requests for examinations scheduled by the office of the registrar (e.g., December and April exams) and for practical laboratory and performance tests (typically scheduled during the last week of the term).

Students should also note that the instructor may **designate** one assessment per course per term that requires supporting documentation. This designated assessment is described elsewhere in this document. Academic consideration requests may be denied when flexibility in assessment has already been included. Examples of flexibility in assessment include when there are assessments not required for calculation of the final grade (e.g. 8 out of 10 quizzes), when there is flexibility in

the submission timeframe (e.g. 72 hour no late penalty period), or when timed assessments (e.g., quizzes) are available over an extended period of time (e.g., when you are given a 72 hour time period to start – and finish – the assessment).

Please note that any academic considerations granted in this course will be determined by the instructor of this course, in consultation with the academic advisors in your Faculty of Registration, in accordance with information presented in this course syllabus. Supporting documentation for academic considerations for absences due to illness should use the Student Medical Certificate or, where that is not possible, equivalent documentation by a health care practitioner.

Accommodation for Religious Holidays

Students should review the policy for Accommodation for Religious Holidays. Where a student will be unable to write examinations and term tests due to a conflicting religious holiday, they should inform their instructors as soon as possible but not later than two weeks prior to writing the examination/term test. In the case of conflict with a midterm test, students should inform their instructor as soon as possible but not later than one week prior to the midterm.

Special Examinations

A Special Examination is any examination other than the regular examination, and it may be offered only with the permission of the Dean of the Faculty in which the student is registered, in consultation with the instructor and Department Chair. Permission to write a Special Examination may be given on the basis of compassionate or medical grounds with appropriate supporting documents. To provide an opportunity for students to recover from the circumstances resulting in a Special Examination, the University has implemented Special Examination dates. The Faculty of Health Sciences has set School-specific dates for these Special Examinations. Please speak with your instructor about the date on which the Special Examination for this course will be held.

Academic Offences

Scholastic offences are taken seriously and students are directed to read the appropriate policy, specifically, the definition of what constitutes a Scholastic Offence, at the following website: https://www.uwo.ca/univsec/pdf/academic_policies/appeals/scholastic_discipline_undergrad.pdf

Plagiarism

Student work is expected to be original. Plagiarism is a serious academic offence and could lead to a zero on the assignment in question, a zero in this course, or your expulsion from the university. You are plagiarizing if you insert a phrase, sentence or paragraph taken directly from another author without acknowledging that the work belongs to him/her. Similarly, you are plagiarizing if you paraphrase or summarize another author's ideas without acknowledging that the ideas belong to someone else. All papers may be subject to submission for textual similarity review to the commercial plagiarism detection software under license to the University for the detection of plagiarism. All papers submitted will be included as source documents in the reference database for the purpose of detecting plagiarism of papers subsequently submitted to the system. Use of the service is subject to the licensing agreement, currently between Western University and Turnitin.com (www.turnitin.com).

Use of Artificial Intelligence for the Completion of Course Work

Within this course, you may only use artificial intelligence tools (e.g., "ChatGPT") in ways that are specifically authorized by the course instructor. All submitted work must reflect your own thoughts and independent written work.

Re-submission of Previously Graded Material
Without the explicit written permission of the instructor, you may not submit any academic work for which credit has been obtained previously, or for which credit is being sought, in another course or program of study in the University or elsewhere.

Use of Statistical Pattern Recognition on Multiple Choice Exams
Computer-marked multiple-choice tests and/or exams may be subject to submission for similarity review by software that will check for unusual coincidences in answer patterns that may indicate cheating.

Accessibility Statement
Please contact the course instructor if you require material in an alternate format or if you require any other arrangements to make this course more accessible to you. You may also wish to contact Accessible Education (AE) at 661-2111 x 82147 for any specific question regarding an accommodation or review The policy on Accommodation for Students with Disabilities

Correspondence Statement
The centrally administered e-mail account provided to students will be considered the individual's official university e-mail address. It is the responsibility of the account holder to ensure that e-mail received from the University at their official university address is attended to in a timely manner. Students are further expected to attend to announcements presented through Brightspace, and to read emails generated in this way.

Use of Electronic Devices

During Exams
Unless you have medical accommodations that require you to do so, or explicit permission from the instructor of the course, you may not use any electronic devices (e.g., cell phones, tablets, cameras, smart glass, smart watches, or iPods) during ANY tests, quizzes, midterms, examinations, or other in-class evaluations. **These devices MUST either be left at home or with your belongings at the front of the room. They MUST NOT be at your test/exam desk or in your pocket. Any student found with a prohibited device will receive an automatic grade of zero on the test or exam.**

During Lectures and Tutorials
Although you are welcome to use a computer during lecture and tutorial periods, you are expected to use the computer for scholastic purposes only, and refrain from engaging in any activities that may distract other students from learning. From time to time, your professor may ask the class to turn off all computers, to facilitate learning or discussion of the material presented in a particular class.

Copyright and Audio/Video Recording Statement
Course material produced by faculty is copyrighted and to reproduce this material for any purposes other than your own educational use contravenes Canadian Copyright Laws. Unless explicitly noted otherwise, you may not make audio or video recordings of lectures – nor may you edit, re-use, distribute, or re-broadcast any of the material posted to the course website.

Contingency Plan for an In-Person Class Pivoting to 100% Online Learning
In the event of a situation that requires this course to pivot to online content delivery, all remaining course content will be delivered entirely online, either synchronously (i.e., at the times indicated in

the timetable) or asynchronously (e.g., posted on Brightspace for students to view at their convenience). The grading scheme will **not** change. Any remaining assessments will also be conducted online as determined by the course instructor

Note that disruptive behaviour of any type during online classes, including inappropriate use of the chat function, is unacceptable. Students found guilty of Zoom-bombing a class or of other serious online offenses may be subject to disciplinary measures under the Code of Student Conduct.

Online Proctoring

Tests and examinations in this course may be conducted using a remote proctoring service. By taking this course, you are consenting to the use of this software and acknowledge that you will be required to provide **personal information** (including some biometric data) and the session will be **recorded**. Completion of this course will require you to have a reliable internet connection and a device that meets the technical requirements for this service. More information about this remote proctoring service, including technical requirements, is available on Western's Remote Proctoring website at: https://remoteproctoring.uwo.ca.

Appealing a Grade Within this Course

You have the right to appeal any grade within this course. The grounds for a grade appeal may be one or more of: medical or compassionate circumstances, extenuating circumstances beyond the student's control, bias, inaccuracy, or unfairness. All grounds advanced in a request for relief must be supported by a clear and detailed explanation of the reasons for the request together with all supporting documentation.

Appeals generally proceed in this order:

1. Course instructor (informal consultation)
2. Department Chair (submission of written request)
3. The Dean of the Faculty (submission of written request)

In the case of perceived procedural unfairness, steps 2 and 3 are carried out within the Department and Faculty offering the course. In the case of extenuating medical or compassionate circumstances that impact on a grade, steps 2 and 3 are carried out within a student's Home Department and Faculty.

A request for relief against a mark or grade must be initiated with the instructor as soon as possible after the mark is issued. In the event that the instructor is not available to the student, or fails to act, or if the matter is not resolved satisfactorily with the instructor, a written request for relief must be submitted to the Chair of the Department within three weeks of the date that the mark was issued. In the case of a final grade in a course, the written request for relief must be submitted to the Chair of the department by January 31st (for first-term half courses) or June 30th (for second-term half courses or full-year courses).